FOR ACCOUNTANTS + BOOKKEEPERS

10 Fable 5 Prompts for a 2-Hour Month-End Close.

Claude Fable 5 is the strongest model Anthropic has ever shipped, and it is sitting inside every paid Claude plan right now. These 10 prompts turn it into your **close checklist builder, reconciliation triage desk, and client-communication department** — each one built for the work that actually eats the first week of your month.

FABLE 5 FREE WINDOW CLOSES JULY 19

Fable 5 is included in paid Claude plans until July 19, 2026 at 11:59 PM PT — after that it moves to usage credits. Run these while it costs you nothing extra.

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COPY-PASTE PROMPTS	PARTS PER PROMPT: ROLE TO FORMAT	REUSABLE ASSET PER PROMPT

How to run these in 3 steps.

No technical setup. If you can paste a trial balance, you can run every prompt in this pack.

1

Open Claude and pick Fable 5

Go to `claude.ai` (or Claude Code if you use it) and select **Fable 5** in the model picker. It is included in every paid plan until July 19 — no extra cost during the window.

2

Paste the prompt, fill the [BRACKETS]

Copy a prompt from this pack exactly as written. Everything in `[UPPERCASE BRACKETS]` is yours to fill — the trial balance export, the unreconciled items, your close process as it really runs. The more real detail you paste, the better the output. Fable 5 handles huge amounts of context, so do not summarize — paste the whole export.

3

Save the output as a template

Every prompt here produces something reusable — a close calendar, a PBC chase sequence, an engagement-scope framework. Save each one. That is the point: you keep the asset long after the free window closes.

Pro habit: end every session with one more line.

Before you close the chat, type: "Turn what you just built into a fill-in-the-blanks template I can reuse for every future client and every future close." Fable 5 will package its own work. That template is yours forever.

01 The Month-End Close Calendar Builder

When to use: once — turn the close that lives in your head into a sequenced calendar the whole team can run.

```
You are a controller who has systematized month-end close for dozens of small firms.

GOAL: Turn my messy real-world close process into a sequenced close calendar with an owner and a done-condition per task, plus a reusable monthly checklist.

CONTEXT: How my close actually runs today, in order, including the chaos: [BRAIN-DUMP EVERY TASK — RECS, ACCRUALS, PAYROLL TIE-OUT, REVIEW, REPORTING]. Who touches it: [TEAM + ROLES]. Current close time: [HONEST DAYS]. The tasks that always slip: [NAME THEM].

CONSTRAINTS: Sequence by dependency, not habit. One owner per task, never "team". Flag pre-close tasks and anything needing professional judgment for reviewer sign-off.

PROCESS: Map dependencies first, sequence into close days 1-5, then compress: challenge every task that claims it must wait.

OUTPUT FORMAT: Close calendar table (day, task, owner, done-condition), pre-close list, and the blank monthly checklist.
```

PRO TIP Brain-dump the chaos honestly — the compression step only works on the real process, not the ideal one.

02 The Bank-Rec Exception Triage Desk

When to use: the moment a reconciliation will not tie — before you burn an afternoon scrolling transactions.

```
You are a senior bookkeeper who clears reconciliation exceptions fast because you categorize before you investigate.

GOAL: Triage my unreconciled items into categories with a specific next action for each, so I clear the rec in one pass instead of item-by-item archaeology.

CONTEXT: The account: [BANK / CC ACCOUNT + PERIOD]. The difference: [AMOUNT]. Unreconciled items, pasted raw: [DATE / DESCRIPTION / AMOUNT FOR EVERY OPEN ITEM]. Known quirks: [TIMING, DUPLICATES, FEES].

CONSTRAINTS: Use only the items I pasted — never invent a transaction or an explanation. Categories: timing difference, likely duplicate, missing entry, bank fee/interest, needs client answer, unknown. Unclassifiable items go to unknown with the exact question that resolves them — no guessing. Not tax or audit advice; flag judgment calls for review.

PROCESS: Find offsetting pairs and near-matches first, classify the rest, then total each category against the difference.

OUTPUT FORMAT: Triage table (item, category, evidence, next action), category totals vs the difference, and the client-question list.
```

PRO TIP Paste both sides — bank feed AND ledger — as two labeled blocks. Offset-matching is where the hours come back.

03 The Variance-Analysis Narrative Writer

When to use: every month-end reporting pack — turn the P&L comparison into an explanation a client actually reads.

```
You are a fractional CFO who explains variances to business owners in plain language, without inventing a single cause.

GOAL: Write the variance commentary for my client's monthly pack — what moved, how much, and why where I know why — in owner-friendly language.

CONTEXT: P&L for [MONTH] vs [PRIOR MONTH / BUDGET / SAME MONTH LAST YEAR]: [PASTE BOTH COLUMNS]. What I know happened this month: [PRICE CHANGES, ONE-OFFS, NEW HIRES — ONLY WHAT YOU KNOW]. The client: [BUSINESS TYPE + WHAT THEY CARE ABOUT].

CONSTRAINTS: Only the numbers I pasted — never invent a figure or a cause. Unknown cause = write "ASK CLIENT:" with the exact question, never speculate. Lead with the 3-5 material variances; one line each for the rest. Not tax advice; flag anything needing professional judgment.

PROCESS: Compute variances, rank by materiality, attach known causes, mark the rest ASK CLIENT, then write.

OUTPUT FORMAT: Summary paragraph, per-variance commentary, ASK CLIENT question list.
```

PRO TIP Send the ASK CLIENT list before the meeting — the client fills the gaps and the commentary finishes itself.

04 The Messy-Books Cleanup Diagnostic

When to use: every inherited file — scope the cleanup before you quote it, not after you are drowning in it.

```
You are a cleanup specialist who diagnoses neglected books before touching a single entry.

GOAL: Diagnose this client file and give me a prioritized cleanup plan — what is broken, what to fix first, and what it means for my quote.

CONTEXT: Trial balance: [PASTE IT]. GL sample from the accounts that look wrong: [PASTE 50-200 LINES]. What the client told me: [THEIR STORY]. Red flags I already spotted: [NEGATIVE BALANCES, SUSPENSE ACCOUNTS, STALE AR/AP].

CONSTRAINTS: Diagnose only from the data I pasted — every finding cites the account and evidence. Rank by risk to financial-statement accuracy, not by size alone. Separate mechanical fixes from needs-client-answer from needs-professional-judgment. Not tax or audit advice.

PROCESS: Scan the TB for structural problems, drill into the GL sample, then sequence fixes so early ones do not get undone.

OUTPUT FORMAT: Findings table (issue, evidence, risk, fix type), sequenced plan, client-question list.
```

PRO TIP Run this before quoting any cleanup job — the findings table doubles as your scope justification.

05 The PBC Document-Chasing Sequence

When to use: build once — then every "still waiting on the bank statements" chase runs on pre-written messages.

```
You are a client-communication specialist for accounting firms whose superpower is getting documents back without nagging.

GOAL: Build my document-chasing system: the initial request that actually gets read, reminders at days 3, 7, and 10, and the escalation that names the consequence — a delayed close — all in my voice.

CONTEXT: What I request monthly: [STATEMENTS, RECEIPTS, LOAN DOCS, PAYROLL REPORTS]. How clients send things now: [PORTAL / EMAIL / SHOEBOX]. My chronic late senders: [HONEST]. My voice: [PASTE 2 EMAILS YOU HAVE SENT CLIENTS].

CONSTRAINTS: Every message skimmable in 10 seconds — the missing-items list sits at the top, never buried. Reminders reference only what is still outstanding. Escalation states the consequence plainly, no guilt-tripping. Nothing that reads like automation.

PROCESS: Write the initial request first, then each reminder as a shorter cut of it, then the escalation.

OUTPUT FORMAT: Five ready-to-send messages with subject lines, plus a blank [CLIENT] / [ITEMS] version for reuse.
```

PRO TIP The day-3 reminder recovers the most documents — most firms wait until day 10 and lose the week.

06 The Recurring Journal Entry SOP Writer

When to use: when the recurring entries live in one person's head — usually yours — and every close depends on remembering them.

```
You are a technical writer for accounting teams who documents processes so a competent newcomer can run them unsupervised.

GOAL: Turn my recurring journal entries into a documented SOP — purpose, calculation, and verification for each — so close no longer depends on my memory.

CONTEXT: My recurring entries: [LIST EACH: ACCOUNTS, CALCULATION, FREQUENCY — DEPRECIATION, ACCRUALS, PREPAIDS, PAYROLL, DEFERRALS]. Source data for each: [WHERE THE NUMBERS COME FROM]. Past mistakes with these entries: [HONEST — THESE BECOME THE WARNINGS].

CONSTRAINTS: Written for a competent bookkeeper who has never seen this file. Every entry gets a verification step. Past mistakes become explicit "watch out" notes. Flag entries involving estimates or judgment as reviewer-sign-off items — not tax advice.

PROCESS: Document each entry, then audit: could a newcomer run this month's entries from the SOP alone? Patch every gap.

OUTPUT FORMAT: One SOP block per entry (purpose, source, calculation, posting steps, verification, watch-outs), then a one-page close-day quick list.
```

PRO TIP This SOP is also your vacation insurance — the first close you skip without panic pays for the hour it took.

07 The New-Client Onboarding Questionnaire

When to use: before every new bookkeeping client — the questions you ask in week one decide how month three feels.

```
You are an onboarding specialist for bookkeeping firms who has seen every way an engagement goes sideways.

GOAL: Build my new-client onboarding questionnaire and document-request pack, so nothing surfaces as a surprise in month three.

CONTEXT: My typical client: [INDUSTRY, SIZE, ENTITY TYPES]. Services: [BOOKKEEPING / PAYROLL / REPORTING]. My stack: [SOFTWARE + APPS]. Surprises that have burned me before: [UNDISCLOSED ACCOUNTS, PERSONAL SPENDING, HIDDEN LOANS].

CONSTRAINTS: Every question exists to prevent a specific future problem — cut pure curiosity. Grouped by topic, plain language, no jargon. Include the access checklist (bank feeds, payroll, merchant, prior accountant). Flag answers needing professional judgment before I commit to scope.

PROCESS: Work backward from my surprises to the questions that catch them, then cover standard ground.

OUTPUT FORMAT: Sectioned questionnaire, document/access checklist, and a red-flags list keyed to answers.
```

PRO TIP The red-flags list is the quiet gold — it tells you which answers mean "raise the price" before you sign.

08 The Advisory Upsell One-Pager

When to use: when a bookkeeping client keeps asking "so how are we doing?" — that question is an advisory engagement waiting to be named.

```
You are a practice-growth advisor who moves bookkeepers from compliance to paid advisory without overpromising.

GOAL: Turn what I already do for [CLIENT] into an advisory one-pager plus the script for offering it at [MONTHLY PRICE].

CONTEXT: What I currently deliver: [THE COMPLIANCE WORK]. Questions this client actually asks me: [THEIR REAL WORDS]. What their numbers show that they ignore: [MARGIN TRENDS, CASH CYCLES — WHAT YOU SEE]. My honest capacity: [HOURS/MONTH].

CONSTRAINTS: Only promise deliverables I listed capacity for — no "strategic partner" fluff. Frame value as decisions made sooner, not reports received. No invented outcomes or savings claims. Tax strategy gets flagged "requires tax professional" — this is management insight, not tax advice.

PROCESS: Map their questions to deliverables, define the monthly rhythm, then write both pieces.

OUTPUT FORMAT: One-pager (name, what you get, rhythm, price) plus the 5-line opener.
```

PRO TIP Use the client's own questions as the one-pager headings — they cannot say no to their own words.

09 The Scope-Creep-Proof Engagement Letter

When to use: every new engagement and every renewal — the letter is where "can you just quickly..." goes to die.

```
You are a practice-management consultant who writes engagement scopes that prevent scope creep instead of documenting it after the fact.

GOAL: Draft the scope section of my engagement letter for [CLIENT + SERVICE] — what is included, what is explicitly excluded, and how out-of-scope requests get handled and priced — plus a reusable scope framework for every future engagement.

CONTEXT: The service: [EXACT DELIVERABLES + FREQUENCY]. My price: [FEE + BILLING RHYTHM]. The "quick favors" clients historically sneak in: [1099 QUESTIONS, PAYROLL FIXES, LOAN APPLICATION DOCS, "QUICK CALLS" — YOUR REAL LIST]. Assumptions the fee depends on: [TRANSACTION VOLUME, CLEAN BOOKS, RESPONSE TIMES].

CONSTRAINTS: Every historical "quick favor" appears by name in included or excluded — no gray zone. Excluded items get a path, not just a no ("available at [RATE]"). Assumptions section states what happens when they break. Plain language a client reads without a lawyer. This is a scope draft, not legal advice — have it reviewed before use.

PROCESS: Sort my real favor-list into included/excluded/priced-extra, write the scope, then stress-test it against each favor: is the answer now obvious?

OUTPUT FORMAT: Scope section ready to paste into my letter, the out-of-scope rate card, and the blank framework for future engagements.
```

PRO TIP The rate card does the awkward talking — "happy to, that is covered under the advisory rate" ends the favor economy politely.

Halfway habit: chain the outputs.

These prompts compound. Paste the close calendar from Prompt 1 into Prompt 6 so the SOPs land on the right close days. Paste the red-flags list from Prompt 7 into Prompt 9 so the scope excludes what onboarding warned you about. Fable 5 holds all of it in one conversation — use that.

10 The Workflow Automation Triage

When to use: once a quarter — decide which recurring tasks deserve automation and which never will, with honest verdicts.

```
You are an operations consultant for accounting firms who gives honest build-vs-never verdicts — you have seen too many half-built Zaps rot in production.

GOAL: Triage my recurring tasks into automate-now, automate-later, and never-automate — with a concrete first step for each automate-now item using tools I already own.

CONTEXT: My recurring tasks with honest time costs: [TASK / FREQUENCY / MINUTES — CHASING DOCS, CATEGORIZING, REPORT SENDING, INVOICE REMINDERS, DATA ENTRY]. My stack: [QBO/XERO, DEXT/HUBDOC, EMAIL, PORTAL, ANYTHING WITH ZAPIER/N8N ACCESS]. My comfort with tech: [HONEST]. What I tried before that died: [AND WHY].

CONSTRAINTS: Never-automate is a real verdict — anything requiring professional judgment, client trust, or review stays human, say so plainly. No tool purchases in automate-now; my existing stack only. Every verdict shows the math: minutes saved per month vs setup effort. No vendor hype.

PROCESS: Score each task on frequency, rule-basedness, and judgment required, then sort into the three buckets, then spec the first automation step for the top 3.

OUTPUT FORMAT: Triage table (task, verdict, reasoning, monthly minutes), and a first-step build note for each automate-now item.
```

PRO TIP If the top automate-now item is document chasing, you already wrote the messages — Prompt 5 becomes the sequence your automation sends.

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Want the full 40-prompt master list?

This pack is the accounting cut of a bigger system. The complete guide — 40 master prompts across dev, automation, agency growth, content, and strategy — is free on the blog:

https://www.skynetjoe.com/blog/claude-fable-5-prompts-40-master-prompts